



LETTUCE SEA SLUG

BLACK-MARGINED SEA SLUG

SPOTTED SEA HARE

VARIABLE NEON SEA SLUG

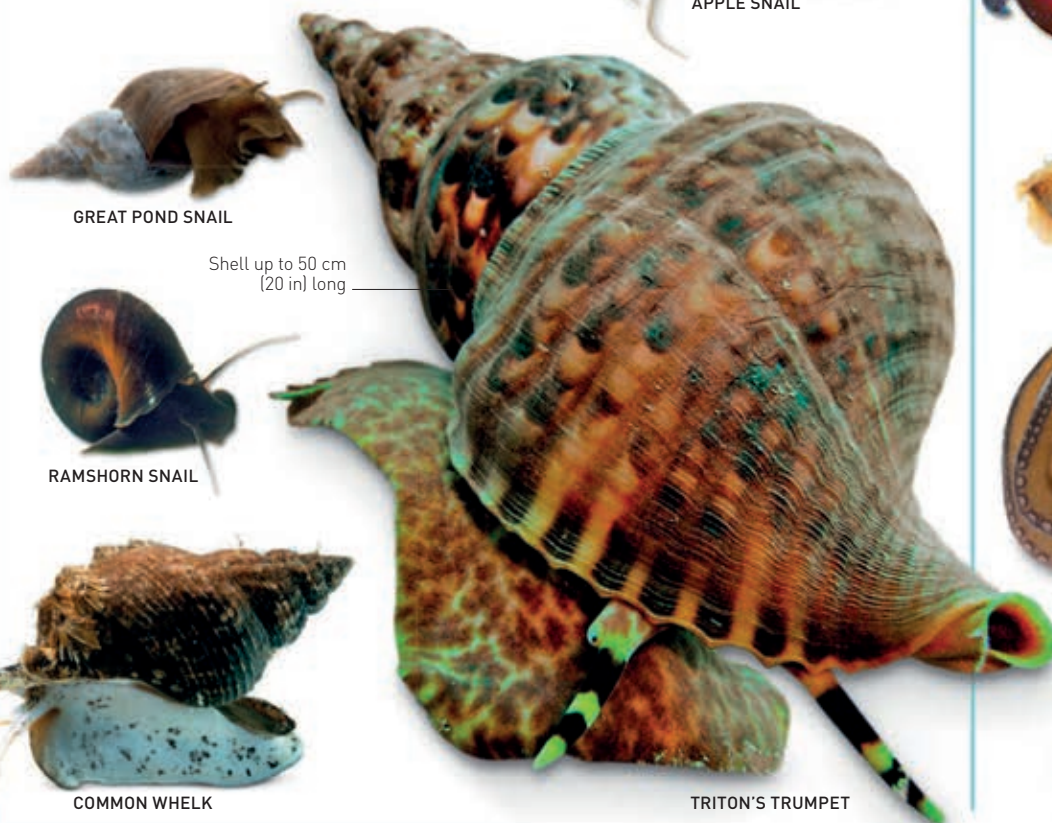
AQUATIC SNAILS

Some of these snails live in the sea, others in fresh water. Sea snails are often highly colourful. Many have spectacular spiralling shells, like the huge Triton's trumpet snail, a predator that injects poison into its prey.



DOG WHELK

APPLE SNAIL



GREAT POND SNAIL

Shell up to 50 cm (20 in) long

RAMSHORN SNAIL

COMMON WHELK

TRITON'S TRUMPET

SURPRISING RELATIVES

The octopus seems an unlikely relative of slugs and snails, but it is in the same major scientific group – the molluscs. Many other animals, perhaps just as unexpected, also belong to this group. Some of them are shown here.



SMALL GIANT CLAM



AUSTRALIAN GIANT CUTTLEFISH



GEODUCK CLAM



COMMON CUTTLEFISH



PACIFIC THORNY OYSTER



COMMON OCTOPUS



MARbled CHITON



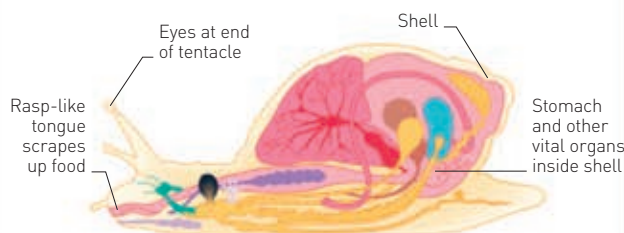
BIGFIN REEF SQUID



NAUTILUS

BONELESS BODIES

Slugs and snails have no bones. Their soft bodies consist of a head, a central part containing the organs, and an underside, or "foot", that they use for moving. The head carries one or two pairs of tentacles that contain eyes and other sense organs.



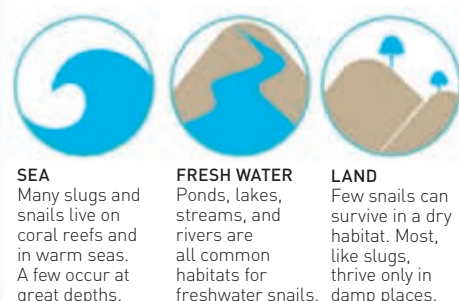
SHELL SHAPES

Most snails have spiral shells, which come in many shapes and sizes. More unusual types of shells usually belong to sea snails. Among the variations are elegantly twisted cones, irregular shapes bristling with spikes, and flat shells like caps.



HABITATS

There are tens of thousands of different slugs and snails living in a wide variety of habitats. They are found on mountains and seabeds, and in rivers, forests, and gardens.



SEA
Many slugs and snails live on coral reefs and in warm seas. A few occur at great depths.

FRESH WATER
Ponds, lakes, streams, and rivers are all common habitats for freshwater snails.

LAND
Few snails can survive in a dry habitat. Most, like slugs, thrive only in damp places.